



# **PAYMENT RAILS WITHOUT BORDERS: THE RISE OF STABLECOINS**

Whitepaper



## 1.1 Introduction and Definitions

Stablecoins are cryptocurrencies that have their value paired with a fiat currency, most commonly the USD; however recent years have seen the growth of euro-backed coins and other alternatives. Stablecoins exist both on public and private blockchains; as a result, stablecoins inherit the efficiencies of blockchain technology, such as speed, low costs, programmability, interoperability, and more.

Juniper Research defines a stablecoin as:

*A stablecoin is a cryptocurrency that has its value pegged or tied to a fiat currency.*

Some other definitions that are important to note:

- **Blockchain:** A blockchain is a decentralised, distributed, and immutable digital ledger that records transactions across a network of computers; ensuring data integrity without a centralised authority.
- **Smart contracts:** A smart contract is a self-executing, digital agreement with terms directly written into code that automatically enforces and executes obligations on a blockchain network without intermediaries.
- **On-chain:** This refers to data, transactions, or activities directly recorded and validated on a blockchain network; making them public, permanent, and immutable. In short, it is anything that happens on the main blockchain ledger.
- **Decentralised Finance (DeFi):** This is a blockchain-based financial system which removes intermediaries such as banks and brokers, and replaces them with smart contracts on blockchains such as Ethereum to enable lending, borrowing, and trading directly between users, on-chain.

## 1.2 The Current Landscape

Since the early 2010s, stablecoins have evolved from narrow, crypto-native settlement tools primarily used by traders, into programmable, dollar-denominated instruments increasingly capable of rivalling traditional payment and settlement flows, both domestic and international. Stablecoins have matured as the infrastructure enabling and supporting them has improved. Advances in custody, compliance, reserves transparency, and Multi-Party Computation (MPC)-based wallet infrastructure – provided by companies such as Anchorage Digital and Fireblocks – are enabling enterprises and asset managers to hold and transfer stablecoins with bank-grade security and internal controls. Compliance tooling, including transaction monitoring, sanctions screening, and wallet risk scoring, from firms such as Chainalysis, allows stablecoin flows to integrate with strict anti-money laundering (AML)/Know Your Customer (KYC) and travel rule obligations; making them suitable for highly regulated environments. Equally, reserve transparency has become the norm; following a rich history of depegging events and other idiosyncratic risks commonly associated with opaque practices in the crypto markets. Stablecoin issuers such as Circle and Paxos were among the first to provide regular attestations and disclosures of reserves supporting their respective stablecoins, often performed by legitimate third-party firms. Scalable on and off ramps, provided by platforms such as Stripe, PayPal, and MoonPay, are reducing the friction between bank accounts and blockchains; allowing stablecoins to move freely between traditional finance and on-chain environments. Collectively, these factors have contributed greatly to the transformation of stablecoins in becoming credible settlement assets suitable for enterprise treasury, cross-border commerce, and institutional capital flows.

Today, stablecoins are increasingly being used for invoice settlements, payroll, remittances, merchant acceptance, and capital markets. This is because stablecoins offer faster settlement, continuous availability, and lower costs, while simultaneously integrating with existing payment ecosystems rather than attempting wholesale replacement. For cross-border and institutional contexts, stablecoins increasingly bypass correspondent banking chains, which are long dependent on networks such as SWIFT. They do this by enabling near-instant, atomic settlement that reduces prefunding requirements, reconciliations, and counterparty exposure when compared with traditional, real-time, gross settlement systems such as Fedwire and



the Clearing House Interbank Payments System (CHIPS), or regional, batch-based schemes such as Single Euro Payments Area (SEPA). At the same time, stablecoins are integrating into consumer and merchant payments through partnerships with incumbent card networks; allowing users to spend stablecoin balances while merchants continue to receive fiat settlement within familiar acceptance frameworks. Collaborations with networks such as Visa and Mastercard abstract away blockchain complexity; effectively embedding stablecoins beneath the card layer while preserving global reach, dispute handling, and merchant tooling.

In rural, underbanked, and unbanked regions, where legacy banking infrastructure and financial rails have historically failed to deliver accessible financial products and services, stablecoins are emerging as tangible solutions to persistent economic frictions. These digital assets can be held and transferred via mobile devices with only intermittent Internet access. The economic rationale for their adoption in these contexts is straightforward: stablecoins provide a low-volatility medium of exchange and a store of value in environments where local currencies are subject to sharp depreciation, where correspondent banking relationships are weak or non-existent, and where traditional remittance channels are prohibitively costly. Regions afflicted by hyperinflation, severe currency depreciation, or political instability have seen organic uptake of stablecoins as hedges against collapsing purchasing power. Nigeria, for example, has witnessed significant stablecoin adoption as a practical response to naira volatility and inflationary pressures. Between July 2023 and June 2024, Nigerian users processed nearly \$22 billion in stablecoin transactions, with stablecoins comprising an outsized share of small-value transfers under \$1 million.

Transaction volumes and overall market activity have shown sustained growth; reflecting both institutional and retail engagement. A number of stablecoins have emerged with compliance-focused structures, with Tether offering a US-regulated variant that aligns with existing banking and securities frameworks. Concurrently, Circle's Payments Network (CPN) has positioned itself as a competitive alternative to traditional settlement networks such as SWIFT; providing real-time cross-border transfers and programmable payment rails that could reshape correspondent banking dynamics. In response, SWIFT has signalled an evolution of its business model by exploring a blockchain-based ledger to complement its messaging services; indicating a strategic pivot toward capturing transaction flows rather than solely facilitating communication between banks.

The European banking sector is also taking active steps to embrace stablecoins at scale, with a consortium of EU institutions launching a euro-pegged stablecoin. Such initiatives underscore the growing institutional recognition of stablecoins as viable instruments for domestic and cross-border settlement. These developments are mirrored by broader experimentation with tokenised assets, including tokenised bank deposits exemplified by JP Morgan's JPM Coin, which further integrate digital currency solutions into existing financial infrastructures while maintaining ties to regulated banking entities.

Overall, stablecoins are becoming more closely tied to traditional financial systems while also gaining traction in cross-border payments and underserved markets. At the same time, conversations between builders and regulators are intensifying. Together, these trends point to a gradual shift: stablecoins are moving beyond experimental use cases and becoming part of mainstream financial infrastructure. This transition carries important implications for liquidity management, how monetary policy is transmitted, and the future shape of global payment networks. Looking ahead, the speed and scale of adoption will both likely be driven by institutional participation, the tokenisation of traditional assets, and how effectively stablecoin models align with evolving regulatory frameworks.

### 1.3 Stablecoins Versus Traditional Payment Rails

The global payments industry settled approximately \$195 trillion in cross-border transactions in 2024; generating a revenue pool of roughly \$2.4 trillion across a deeply embedded architecture of correspondent banking networks, card scheme rails, batch processors, and real-time interbank systems. This infrastructure has been constructed and refined over decades, and while its institutional depth is unmatched, it carries structural costs in fees, latency, and fragmentation, which has created a measurable space for an alternative settlement mechanism to emerge.

Traditional rails span a diverse set of technical systems; each designed for a specific market segment. For instance, SWIFT connects over 11,000 financial institutions across 200 countries, although it functions as a messaging protocol rather than a direct settlement mechanism. Actual fund movement occurs through correspondent banking relationships. While SWIFT Global Payments Innovation (GPI) has improved



same-day settlement in major corridors, payments to Global South countries routinely span multiple business days and pass through chains of intermediaries, each extracting a fee. World Bank data indicates that aggregate charges can reach as high as 14.55% of the transaction value on high-cost corridors. Domestic batch systems, such as Automated Clearing House (ACH) and SEPA, operate at a substantially lower per-transaction cost but carry settlement latency. Real-time payment systems such as India’s UPI, Brazil’s PIX, the UK’s Faster Payments, and the US’s FedNow have all meaningfully addressed settlement delay issues domestically; processing an estimated \$6.8 trillion in combined volume in 2024 and enabling near-instantaneous settlement at negligible clearing fees. Card networks such as Visa and Mastercard collectively clear over \$20 trillion annually across near-universal merchant acceptance, but carry interchange fees of 1.5-3.5% of transaction value that represent a material cost burden, particularly in international transactions. For large-value institutional settlement, Fedwire and CHIPS process trillions in daily dollar flows under Federal Reserve oversight, with both systems completing migration to ISO 20022 messaging in July 2025; delivering faster processing and improved interoperability.

Against this backdrop, stablecoins have developed into a credible parallel payments layer. Total stablecoin transaction volume reached \$33 trillion in 2025, a 72% increase year-on-year (YoY), with market capitalisation exceeding \$300 billion. Tether and Circle together accounted for over 93% of that capitalisation, although USDC surpassed USDT in annual transaction volume in 2025: at \$18.3 trillion versus \$13.3 trillion. However, these figures do not consider that a large proportion of on-chain stablecoin transactions are not genuine payment activity. Approximately 70% to over 90% of stablecoin transaction volume is driven by automated bots, high-frequency trading, and large-scale traders rather than organic human activity. McKinsey & Company and The Payments Association estimate that approximately \$390 billion of the roughly \$11 trillion in 2025 stablecoin transactions represented genuine payment activity, with the remainder comprising crypto trading, DeFi interactions, and automated blockchain flows. However, even on an adjusted basis, real stablecoin payment volume more than doubled YoY following three significant milestones – the US GENIUS Act signed in July 2025, the EU’s MiCA framework effective January 2025, and Hong Kong’s Stablecoin Ordinance passed in May 2025. These regulations have shifted the operating environment from regulatory opacity to structured oversight;

imposing reserve requirements, attestation obligations, and AML/KYC standards that bring regulated issuers into alignment with conventional payment institutions.

Figure 1: Comparison Between Payment Instruments

|                                      | STABLECOINS | TOKENIZED DEPOSITS | DEPOSIT TOKENS | CBDCS | TRADITIONAL RAILS |
|--------------------------------------|-------------|--------------------|----------------|-------|-------------------|
| Level of trust and counterparty risk | ?           | ✓                  | ✓              | ✓     | ✓                 |
| Scale and transaction volume         | ?           | ?                  | ?              | ?     | ✓                 |
| Regulatory clarity                   | ?           | ?                  | ?              | ✓     | ✓                 |
| Interoperability                     | ✓           | ?                  | ?              | ?     | ✓                 |
| Programmability                      | ✓           | ✓                  | ✓              | ?     | ✗                 |
| Privacy                              | ?           | ✓                  | ✓              | ✓     | ✓                 |
| Access and inclusion                 | ✓           | ?                  | ?              | ✓     | ?                 |
| 24x7 availability                    | ✓           | ✓                  | ✓              | ✓     | ?                 |

✓ Strong fit   ? Moderate fit/context dependent   ✗ Limited fit/not suitable

Source: Citi Institute

Some of the longest-standing competitive advantages of legacy rails are institutional trust, counterparty infrastructure, and legal clarity. SWIFT’s membership density, Fedwire’s central bank-backed finality, and card networks’ statutory consumer protection frameworks, such as chargebacks, dispute resolution, and zero-liability policies, reflect an institutional architecture that currently no blockchain network is able to replicate at scale. As noted by Citi Institute, stablecoins currently provide a moderate fit on trust and counterparty risk, with a structural absence of deposit insurance, limited recourse against smart contract exploits, and auditability disparities among major issuers. To date, Tether has never submitted to a full independent public audit, whereas Circle publishes monthly third-party attestations



of USDC's reserves. This distinction carries a real contributor to institutional adoption.

Card networks benefit from bilateral network effects that are extremely difficult to replicate. Visa's acceptance across more than 100 million merchant locations and Mastercard's presence in 210 countries reflect decades of infrastructure investment and regulatory negotiations that translate directly into consumer trust and merchant reliance. In contrast, public blockchain settlement is pseudonymous rather than private, where wallet balances and transaction flows are visible to any party with chain access. This represents a deterrent for institutional participants and corporate treasury functions with competitive sensitivity around payment flows. This transparency, paradoxically, is a system feature that functions as an adoption barrier at the participant level.

Stablecoins carry the clearest structural advantage in cross-border payments, particularly across corridors that are expensive, slow, and underserved by correspondent banking infrastructure. The global average remittance cost stood at 6.49% in Q1 2025 according to the World Bank, which is well above the G20's 3% target. Remittances to Sub-Saharan Africa average 8.78%, and bank-to-bank transfers can reach as high as 14.55% on specific corridors. In contrast, stablecoin transfers on high throughput networks such as Aptos, Polygon, and Solana carry on-chain costs as low as fractions of a cent; operating 24 hours a day, seven days a week, without reliance on correspondent bank business hours or batch-processing windows. BVNK's Stablecoin Utility Report 2026, drawing on a survey of 4,600 users across 15 countries, found that stablecoin transfers cost an average of 40% less than traditional remittance channels when total costs are considered.

Beyond remittances, programmable settlement enabled by smart contracts on Ethereum, Solana, Avalanche, and Polygon introduces conditional execution logic for which legacy rails have no equivalent. Programmability via smart contracts unlocks use cases such as automated escrow release, real-time revenue sharing, atomic delivery-versus-payment for tokenised securities, and conditional payroll disbursement. These capabilities are gaining traction in capital markets through platforms such as Ondo Finance, BlackRock's USD Institutional Digital Liquidity (BUIDL) fund, and Franklin Templeton's BENJI, and represent an emerging wave of stablecoin adoption beyond payments into settlement infrastructure more broadly.

Figure 2: Stablecoins Versus Legacy Payment Rails

|                                | Legacy payment rails                                                                                                                                  | Stablecoin                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Speed                          | • 1–5 business days                                                                                                                                   | • Nearly instant settlement                                                                              |
| Cost                           | • International wire: \$15–\$50 per transaction<br>• Automated clearing house: \$0.2–\$1.5 per transaction<br>• Credit card: 1.5%–3.5% of transaction | • <\$0.1 per transaction                                                                                 |
| Cross-border                   | • Relies on correspondent or domestic banking system; additional foreign transaction (FX) fees                                                        | • Borderless, minimal, or nonexistent FX fees                                                            |
| Automation and programmability | • Manual interventions, settlement frictions<br>• Limited API and programmability capabilities                                                        | • Fully digital, smart-contract-enabled programmability                                                  |
| Security                       | • Established banking standards<br>• Employs technology to mitigate fraud risk                                                                        | • Cryptographically secure and irreversible but catastrophically vulnerable to wallet or key theft risks |
| Transparency                   | • Limited visibility into transaction steps                                                                                                           | • Fully transparent transaction reporting on blockchain                                                  |
| Settlement risks               | • Intermediary or correspondent dependency risks                                                                                                      | • Peer-to-peer, with no intermediary risks                                                               |
| Availability                   | • Banking hours or days constraints                                                                                                                   | • Fully operational 24/7/365                                                                             |

Source: McKinsey & Company

Despite this, the competitive position for stablecoins is constrained by the structural frictions that limit their addressable market in practice. For instance, the on-chain cost advantage erodes substantially in cross-border payments when the full transaction is priced to include on-ramp and off-ramp costs: an exchange based on-ramp can charge between 0.1%–1%, whereas a specialist provider can charge between 1–3%, and crypto ATM fees can reach 7% in markets with limited exchange infrastructure. This can narrow the net advantage considerably, especially when comparing to relative providers such as Wise, which settled over 50% of payments within 20 seconds at an average fee of 1.25% in 2025. Off-ramp liquidity remains geographically uneven, with mature local liquidity providers established in key Latin American corridors, but coverage across Sub-Saharan Africa, Central Asia, and parts of Southeast Asia remaining sparse.

Moreover, gas fee volatility for transacting on networks such as Ethereum, which hosts approximately half of all outstanding stablecoin supply, adds cost predictability





risk for treasury and payment operations. Importantly, peg stability of a stablecoin is not guaranteed, which has been demonstrated in the stablecoin market's history of depegging events. Institutions and corporate entities rely on stable value instruments to move capital across borders. However, when a dollar peg is contingent on the creditworthiness of the issuer's reserve custodians, and not the way of deposit insurance, scepticism and reluctance to use stablecoins as a settlement medium increase. The nature of existing on permissionless blockchains also means that holders may be exposed to private key custody risk – the loss or compromise of a wallet private key, which carries no real recovery mechanism straight out of the box. This is qualitatively a different risk profile from a recoverable insured deposit account. Institutional custodians such as Fireblocks, Anchorage Digital, and Coinbase Custody have significantly improved the risk management landscape; however, the risk remains evident.

Whilst there is much debate to the real nature of stablecoins being a replacement for traditional rails, what is clear is the level of institutional adoption, mergers and acquisitions, and partnerships being made in the space by notable incumbents and players. For instance, as of February 2026, Visa's on-chain settlement system processed over \$3.5 billion in annualised transaction volume in USDC through its Ethereum-based programme; Mastercard partnered with Paxos Global Dollar across its network to accelerate regulated stablecoin adoption, in June 2025; and Stripe announced it had agreed to acquire Bridge for \$1.1 billion, in October 2024. Recently, in March 2026, Mastercard announced a definitive agreement to acquire BVNK, a leader in stablecoin infrastructure. Together, these are infrastructure decisions made by organisations that collectively process trillions of dollars annually. Fireblocks' 2025 survey found that 71% of Latin American financial institutions are already using stablecoins for cross-border payments, with some of the highest regional adoption rates globally, and that 88% of North American institutions view stablecoin regulation as an enabler rather than a barrier.

Within that architecture, flows are gravitating toward the rails that carry a structural advantage for each use case. Domestic retail payments in markets with mature real-time payment infrastructure, such as India's UPI, Brazil's Pix, the UK's Faster Payments, and SEPA Instant, are unlikely to shift meaningfully toward stablecoins in the near term, given stablecoins' limited cost and speed advantage, alongside their own stronger consumer protection frameworks and better developed regulatory

infrastructure. For this same structural reason, card rails will retain dominance in consumer retail. However, cross-border payments, particularly in high-cost corridors to the Global South, represent the primary near-term opportunity for stablecoin penetration. This is where the cost and speed differential is most impactful and where existing infrastructure is weakest. Similarly, business-to-business (B2B) cross-border settlement and supply chain finance represent the next adoption wave, with programmability and finality adding to operational value beyond pure cost reduction. On a longer-term horizon, capital market settlements, such as tokenised Treasury bills, bond instruments, and ultimately derivatives and securities settlement, represent an opportunity for stablecoin adoption where atomic delivery-versus-payment could unlock cost reductions that no existing rail can presently match.

A question arises as to whether institutional infrastructure will be built on public, permissionless blockchains, or on private, permissioned alternatives. Examples such as SWIFT's blockchain consortium, Project mBridge, involving central banks of China, Hong Kong, Thailand, and the UAE, and JP Morgan's Onyx all represent permissioned architectures that offer privacy and regulatory backing but are close-looped by design. If those initiatives achieve interoperability at scale, then a material portion of institutional settlement volume may never appear on public stablecoin rails; making the boundary between permissioned and permissionless infrastructure potentially one of the most consequential structural questions in the payments landscape through 2030.

The critical inflection point for broader stablecoin adoption, beyond its established corridors, is the maturation of off-ramp infrastructure. On-chain settlement is already fast, inexpensive, and increasingly regulated. The bottleneck, however, is the last-mile converting of digital dollar balances into spendable local currency across more than 150 markets where no mature off-ramp currently exists at scale. As the infrastructure develops, the addressable market for stablecoin-native payments expands accordingly.

As regulations mature, a significant structural risk to expansion now lies with incumbency. SWIFT's 11,000-member network, Visa's 100 million merchant relationships, and the entire architecture of dollar-denominated global finance is not something that will be disrupted overnight. Which is why the most realistic path forward is not stablecoins replacing the existing system; it is when stablecoins quietly



become part of it. The most probable path to sustained stablecoin adoption is likely through integration rather than displacement: where stablecoin rails operate as a complementary settlement layer embedded within the routing logic of incumbent payment networks and correspondent banking models, accessed by consumers and businesses with no direct awareness of the underlying blockchain infrastructure.

### 1.3.1 Corporate & Institutional Adoption

Corporate and institutional adoption of stablecoins has accelerated as firms increasingly recognise the utility of blockchain-based digital dollars for payments, treasury management, settlement infrastructure, and cross-border financial operations. This transformation is occurring because stablecoins combine several attributes valuable to corporations and financial institutions, including near-instant settlement, programmability, global transferability, and continuous 24/7 availability. The growth of such enterprise use cases demonstrates that stablecoin adoption is not confined to retail crypto markets, but becoming embedded in institutional financial infrastructure and corporate payment systems.

For instance, stablecoins are proving to offer capabilities in corporate treasury management where legacy financial infrastructure struggles to replicate at comparable costs and speeds. Multinational corporations frequently manage liquidity across many subsidiaries and jurisdictions, and rely on correspondent banking networks, multi-day settlement windows, and costly foreign exchange (FX) intermediaries. Such factors have long been a source of operational friction. Traditional cross-border wires often take two to five business days to settle, and fees can rack up to two to five percent when accounting for both correspondent bank charges and foreign exchange spreads. This is where stablecoin settlements have been growing in adoption, as they address these frictions directly. Stablecoin settlements complete in minutes, at a fraction of the cost. This type of capability for corporate treasury management was demonstrated when PayPal executed a corporate payment to Ernst & Young using its proprietary stablecoin PayPal USD (PYUSD) via an enterprise payments hub integrated with the SAP digital payments platform. Another example involves the Argentine agricultural company Adecoagro, which adopted Circle's USDC stablecoin as part of its treasury strategy in 2021. Adecoagro allocated a portion of its corporate cash reserves into USDC as a way to preserve dollar value and manage liquidity more efficiently in a country and

economy characterised by high levels of inflation and strict foreign exchange controls.

One of the most successful implementations of stablecoin-enabled treasury management is JP Morgan's JPM Coin platform, operated under its Kinexys division. JPM Coin runs on a private blockchain called Quorum, an enterprise-permissioned version of Ethereum developed by the bank. It functions similarly to a stablecoin by maintaining a 1:1 peg with the US dollar, but is technically classified as a tokenised bank deposit. Each JPM Coin represents a claim on US dollar deposits held at the bank: when a client deposits dollars with JP Morgan, they can receive an equivalent amount of JPM Coin that can be transferred across the distributed ledger and redeemed back into dollars at any time. The most consequential innovation in JP Morgan's permissioned blockchain is programmable payments – the ability to embed conditional logic into payment instructions; enabling money to move autonomously when predefined business conditions are met. Siemens AG, a German multinational technology conglomerate focused on industrial automation, infrastructure, transport, and healthcare, executed its first programmable payment using this functionality. FedEx, a global courier company, also confirmed that its company had gone live with the Onyx JPM Coin system to streamline its global cash management. From a treasury management perspective, the implications are great, as companies are now able to use blockchain-enabled programmable money to carry out cash sweeps that previously occurred once a day. Finance firms are using smart contracts to monitor and address margin calls for securities, and logistics companies are arranging for shipping payments to be released at various stages of a voyage. The Group Treasurer of Siemens AG stated that the integration would take the company to the next level of automation, not only optimising the use of working capital but enabling data-driven digital business models and supporting the scalability of its treasury operations.

Stablecoins are being used to eliminate structural inefficiencies in B2B payment flows, particularly across borders. The inefficiencies stem largely from the architecture of the current correspondent banking network and SWIFT messaging system used for cross-border B2B payments. Most cross-border payments move through multiple correspondent banks before reaching the beneficiary bank, with fees often charged, compliance checks performed, and operational risk introduced. Stablecoins, instead, operate on a shared ledger settlement layer; allowing direct



wallet-to-wallet (W2W) settlement without correspondent banks. This makes stablecoin a viable and attractive form of settlement for B2B and cross-border payments. Revolut, a fast-growing neobank, announced that it is using USDC and USDT to help businesses pay international suppliers without incurring traditional foreign exchange fees of 1-3%; translating to savings of tens of thousands of dollars on million dollar transactions.

Stablecoins are also increasingly used by companies as part of payment acceptance strategies, particularly in global eCommerce and digital services where customers operate across multiple jurisdictions. For example, the eCommerce platform Shopify has enabled merchants to accept stablecoin payments, such as USDC, through integrated payment applications; motivated by demand from international sellers seeking faster settlement and lower transaction fees. In similar fashion, businesses ranging from entertainment companies such as AMC Theatres to luxury brands such as Gucci have experimented with accepting stablecoins as a payment method; expanding the range of real-world transactions conducted using blockchain-based dollars.

Traditional payment processors and card networks have begun integrating stablecoin settlement capabilities in order to modernise their backend clearing systems. A significant example is the decision by Visa to allow participating banks to settle transactions using USDC; enabling issuer and acquiring banks to finalise obligations through blockchain transfers rather than conventional bank wires. This system enables continuous settlement availability across weekends and holidays while improving liquidity efficiency for financial institutions. Initial participants such as Cross River Bank and Lead Bank have already begun settling obligations with Visa through USDC transactions on blockchain networks; demonstrating how stablecoins can function as a wholesale settlement asset in mainstream financial infrastructure.



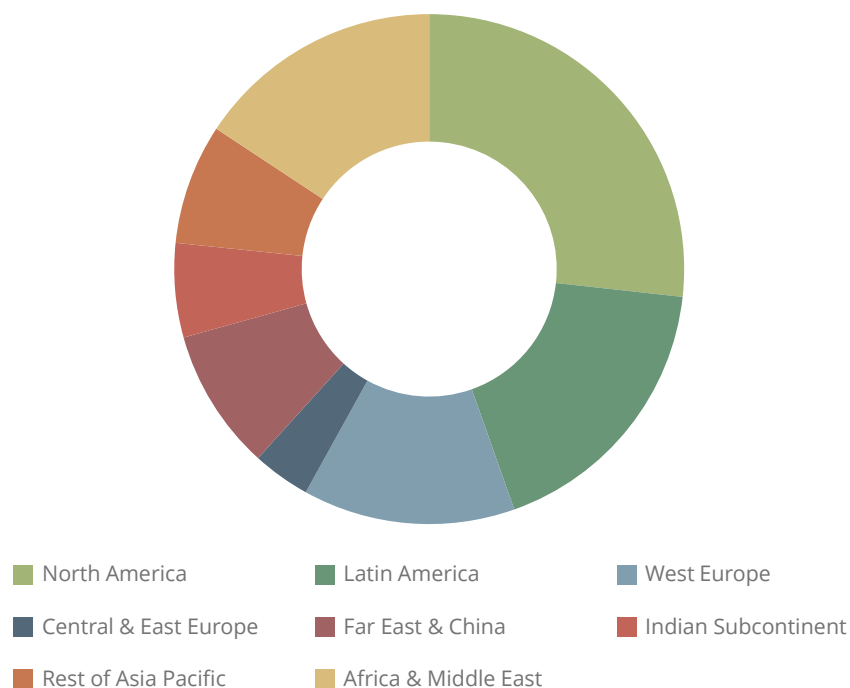


## 1.4 Market Forecast Summary: Total Value of Stablecoin Transactions

Juniper Research has found that the total value of cross-border B2B stablecoin transactions will reach \$8.4 trillion by 2035; rising from \$23.4 billion in 2026. The growth is driven by stablecoins increasingly addressing inefficiencies within cross-border payments.

Stablecoin transactions include person-to-person (P2P), person-to-business (P2B), B2B, business-to-consumer (B2C), and crypto card use cases.

Figure 3: Total Value of Stablecoin Transactions in 2035, Split by 8 Key Regions, (%)



Source: Juniper Research

The research found that 85% of stablecoin transaction value in 2035 will be B2B, with stablecoins shifting from a speculative asset to a foundational layer of institutional payment infrastructure. Stablecoins are increasingly embedded in cross-border B2B transactions, treasury operations, and supply chain settlements, where their programmability and 24/7 settlement finality offer advantages over correspondent banking rails.

### Cross-border B2B Payments to Dominate

The report identified cross-border B2B payments as the largest driver of stablecoin transaction value growth through 2035. Traditional correspondent banking introduces settlement delays and intermediary costs such as correspondent fees, FX conversion margins, and SWIFT messaging charges. Conversely, stablecoins settle on-chain in near real-time, substantially reducing per-transaction costs to a fraction of conventional rails; making it ideal for high-value, time-sensitive corporate transfers across corridors, especially where dollar-denominated stablecoins offer a neutral settlement asset.

Stablecoins are not replacing payments infrastructure; they are being adopted where the advantages are most pronounced. Cross-border B2B is where those advantages are greatest, and it is where we expect the most sustained volume growth over the forecast period. Stablecoin issuers and payment service providers should prioritise enterprise integrations and treasury partnerships to capture the majority of this value.



## Order the Full Research

Featuring extensive insights into the fast-developing stablecoins market, this latest report makes for essential reading. With data split over 61 countries, this new research reveals 19 market leaders in the stablecoin space via a Competitor Leaderboard. Covering trends, drivers, obstacles, and opportunities within the market, such as crypto-backed payment cards, corporate and institutional adoption, and on-chain use-cases, the report enables stakeholders such as central banks, commercial banks, stablecoin issuers, and payment service providers to understand future growth, key trends, and the competitive environment.

### Key Features

- **Market Dynamics:** Insights into key trends and market expansion challenges within the stablecoin market, including trends, drivers, obstacles, and opportunities for the stablecoin market. The report addresses the challenges faced by the cross-border payments sector regarding transaction costs, how integration and partnerships are key for stablecoin usage, and the interplay between stablecoins in financial markets. The research also features a Country Readiness Index assessing the current development and segment growth of the stablecoins market across 8 key regions, as well as providing a future market outlook.
- **Key Takeaways & Strategic Recommendations:** in-depth analysis of key development opportunities and findings within the stablecoins market, accompanied by strategic recommendations for stakeholders.
- **Benchmark Industry Forecasts:** The stablecoins dataset includes forecasts for total value and total volume of the stablecoin market across P2P, P2B, B2B, B2C, and card use cases, including the total volume and value of stablecoin transactions for each use case, respectively.

- **Juniper Research Competitor Leaderboard:** Key market player capability and capacity assessment for 19 stablecoin-issuing vendors, via the Juniper Research Competitor Leaderboard.

### What's in this Research?

1. **Market Trends & Strategies** – Detailed analysis and strategic recommendations for the stablecoin market; analysing the market drivers and trends, as well as key market opportunities.
2. **Competitor Leaderboard** – in-depth analysis of 19 vendors within the space, via the Juniper Research Competitor Leaderboard (PDF).
3. **Market Data & Forecasts** – the forecast suite features the total volume and value of stablecoin transactions across P2P, P2B, B2B, B2C, and card use cases.
4. **Interactive Forecast Excel** – highly granular dataset comprising over 39,000 datapoints, allied to an interactive scenario tool; giving users the ability to manipulate Juniper Research's data.
5. **harvest Online Data Platform** – 12 months' access to all the data in our online data platform, including continuous data updates and exportable charts, tables, and graphs.

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